

Asian CHI Symposium: HCI Research from Asia and on Asian Contexts and Cultures

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ABSTRACT

The Asian CHI symposium is an annual event organized by researchers and practitioners in Asia. The symposium aims to bring together both early-career and senior HCI academia and UX practitioners from industries in Asia and bring about cross-exchange of information and transfer of knowledge in a multidisciplinary environment and multi-socio-economic aspects of HCI research and also foster social ties and collaboration in the field of HCI. Beyond showcasing the latest Asian-inspired HCI work and those focusing on incorporating Asian sociocultural factors in their design, implementation, evaluation, and improvement, the Asian CHI Symposium 2023 is a sandbox for academically rigorous discourse platform for both HCI academic and UX practitioners to present their latest research findings and solutions that reflect the expansion of HCI theory and applications towards culturally inclusive design for diverse audiences in Asia. In addition to circulating ideas and envisioning future research in HCI, this symposium aims to foster social networks among academics (researchers and students) and practitioners and grow a research community from Asia.

CCS CONCEPTS

• Human-centered computing; • Human-Computer Interaction (HCI);

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KEYWORDS

User interfaces, Interaction design, Interactive systems, Interaction techniques, Technology design, Asia

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1 INTRODUCTION

The field of Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) uses insights on how social, cultural, economic, and political identities shape the way people interact with technologies. While the Global North researchers have mainly been instrumental in developing HCI, the Asian counterparts contribute by exploring a variety of applied research directions, expanding the HCI theory and applications towards culturally inclusive design for diverse Asian cultures and societies [1]. Despite its emerging contribution towards the HCI body of knowledge, the relatively small and nascent HCI research community in Asia faces the challenges of underrepresentation, marginalization, inequality, and colonization. Rather than recognizing the diversity of Asian cultures and societies, many international HCI events often impose on many aspects that result in a virtual barrier for Asian HCI researchers to participate in a positive and engaging space. The use of English as the unofficial research language and publication, relatively high financial requirements for publication and participation in international HCI events, time zone differences, and lack of observation for religious customs, insufficient experience in presenting the work in bigger international venues, are some limiting factors that we have learned for the last eight years since 2015-2022 [2–9]. Thus, it has become urgent to

provide academically rigorous discourse platform for both HCI academic and UX practitioners to present their latest research findings and solutions that reflect the expansion of HCI theory and applications towards culturally inclusive design for diverse audiences in Asia.

To this end, there have been several symposiums organized by the authors, at the CHI conference since 2015. These symposia include Asia-Pacific CHI Symposium (later called SEACHI) and Asian CHI Symposium (see Table 1). However, despite consistent efforts in growing diversity in the main and specialized conferences, research from Asia is still under-represented [10].

Table 1: Timeline of Asian CHI Symposiums at CHI from 2015-present

Year	Asia Community at CHI
2015	Crossing HCI in the Asia Pacific [2, 12]
2016	SEACHI [3, 13]
2017	Asian CHI Symposium [4]
2018	Asian CHI Symposium [5, 14]
2019	Asian CHI Symposium [6, 15]
2020	Asian CHI Symposium [7, 16]
2021	Asian CHI Symposium [8, 17]
2022	Asian CHI Symposium [9], SEACHI [11]

HCI in Asia is beyond research, as the researchers do not just pursue the knowledge but also apply and translate the work in the community. At CHI 2023, we will showcase HCI works that reflect the expansion of HCI theory and applications towards culturally inclusive design for diverse audiences in Asia. This symposium will become a sandbox for academically rigorous discourse platforms for both HCI academic and UX practitioners to present their latest research findings and solutions that reflect the expansion of HCI theory and applications towards culturally inclusive design for diverse audiences in Asia. We will continue inviting esteemed and emerging HCI researchers to give keynote speeches, inspire future research, and urge participants to embark on new problems, sub-fields, or methods. These actions contribute towards our mission of providing a high-quality venue for Asian HCI researchers to have international exchanges. It is also aimed to be a place for young researchers and students to interact with other senior and junior colleagues. We will also continue the missions from last year that are to improve the quality of submissions to proudly present quality HCI research from Asia on the ACM Digital Library and improve the geographical diversity of the authors and the participants.

2 EXPECTED OUTCOMES AND MEASUREMENTS

Our main objectives and key results (OKRs) can be derived as follows.

- We aim for the number of participants to be about 30;
- We aim to have at least 20% of the participants being early-career researchers and practitioners;

- We will continue the shepherding of near-acceptance submissions, which provide ample opportunities for first-time or inexperienced participants to improve the quality of their publications. The shepherding process will track the quality of the submissions selected for shepherding. With this, we aim to see significant improvement in the publication quality (for details, see the Call for Participation section).

3 SYMPOSIUM DAY AND STRUCTURE

The symposium will be conducted fully online over two days, where the first day the accepted papers will be shared and presented, and the second day, we plan to conduct an interactive session among the participants to discuss on potential collaboration, or critical matters pertaining their research in Asia. Placing the symposium on Friday and Saturday before the CHI 2023 conference allows a gap day before the main conference begins. Similar to the past, many participants are local chapter leaders and will be representing their local SIGCHI chapters. Having the symposium on Friday and Saturday allows them to participate in the meeting of SIGCHI Local Chapters on Sunday or other pre-CHI community activities.

3.1 Oral presentations

With the new norm, all authors with accepted submissions are expected to present their works using online presentations on a virtual platform. There will be a “prime time” slot for each work in which authors are to present the work to the audience.

We will use the online conferencing tool provided by the CHI workshop committee to provide some CHI experience to our attendees. In addition to that, we will also include the Slack platform to facilitate further discussions. We will collect the pre-recorded videos from the accepted position paper presenters and play them during the session to avoid network-related issues. However, the authors will answer the questions from the audience online after their presentation.

3.2 Plenary and keynote speeches

In the plenary session, we will invite esteemed speakers who work in the Asian regions or Asian-related projects to inspire the Asian community. Each talk will be 30 minutes, including Q&A.

4 PRE-SYMPOSIUM PLANS

We will set up a website that will host the call for papers and future programs and share the missions and the process of organizing the symposium, besides highlighting our past events. It will serve as an organizational memory for future organizers. We will promote the symposium actively on Facebook, Twitter, and mailing lists related to SIGCHI activity postings. Before the symposium, we will use a Slack channel for announcements among the registered attendees for icebreaking and speed-networking.

5 POST-SYMPOSIUM PLANS

After the symposium, we will assess the attainment of our expected outcomes and share them with the rest of the community (see section Expected Outcomes and Measurements).

5.1 Publication

Original submissions that are accepted to present may choose to have their camera-ready submissions listed in the ACM Digital Library as abstract-only, the whole extended abstract, or none at all. These options provide enough flexibility for work-in-progress submissions to continue their work and have it published later in a journal or conference. For authors who will choose to publish their full extended abstracts, there is a shepherding post-symposium: selected mentors will closely work with authors to improve the quality of the manuscript. Only submissions that successfully go through the shepherding will be added to the ACM Digital Library.

For the showcase submissions (that will also be presented in other CHI 2022 tracks or other published HCI materials), their entry in the symposium proceedings will contain only the title and authors with a pointer to the corresponding entry in the CHI 2023 Proceedings or Extended Abstract Proceedings.

6 ORGANIZERS

Dr. Masitah Ghazali is an Associate Professor at the Faculty of Computing, a member of ViCubeLab Research Group, and an IT Associate Fellow at UTM Digital Department at Universiti Teknologi Malaysia (UTM). She currently works on mobile-BCI to make it more accessible to people. She is one of the founding members of the ACM Kuala Lumpur Chapter (myHCI-UX) and served as Chair for two consecutive terms. She currently holds the advisor position.

Dr. Eunice Sari is the CEO and the Co-founder of UX Indonesia. She is an Adjunct Associate Professor at the School of Computer Science and Engineering, Faculty of Engineering, the University of New South Wales (UNSW), and an Honorary Research Fellow of Charles Darwin University. She is the co-founder of the Asian CHI Symposium and SEACHI, which she started in 2022, and the Indonesian ACM SIGCHI, the first ACM SIGCHI Chapter in Southeast Asia. She has spearheaded the awareness and excellence in HCI and UX practices in the Asia Pacific through her projects across disciplines. Besides academic and community work, Eunice has been helping many large and small businesses, including startups and individuals in Asia Pacific, accelerate their digital transformation. Her passion is for empowering female founders or owners, immigrants, young people, and other marginalized communities.

Josh (Adi) Tedjasaputra is a Google-certified Design Sprint Master who builds and nurtures business and innovation at UX Indonesia and Customer Experience Insight Pty Ltd. For more than 20 years, he has been helping international companies in creating business strategy, disruptive technology, marketing, and branding of successful products and services.

Dr Chui Yin Wong is currently the UX Architect at User and Developer Experience (UXDX), Developer Relations (DevRel), Network and Edge Group (NEX) of Intel Corporation. She is also a Program and Technical Assessor for Malaysia Board of Technologists (MBOT) in Art, Design and Creative Multimedia cluster. Prior to joining Intel, she was a Senior Lecturer and UX Consultant at Multimedia University in Malaysia. Her areas of interest are gerontechnology, UI-UX, inclusive design and creative multimedia.

Dr. Ethel Ong is an Associate Professor at the College of Computer Studies, De La Salle University, Manila, Philippines. As a

Senior Researcher at the Center for Language Technologies - Advanced Research Institute for Informatics, Computing and Networking, she leads research teams in the development of automated story generation systems and narrative-based conversational interfaces, believing that computers can better communicate with and understand the needs of their human users by listening to and sharing stories. Her work encompasses the use of conversational storytelling agents or chatbots for mental health awareness, cybersecurity, socio-emotional development, and learning.

Dr. Noris Mohd Norowi is a Senior Lecturer at the Faculty of Computer Science and Information Technology, Universiti Putra Malaysia, Malaysia. She is also the Head of Human-Computer Interaction Lab, Universiti Putra Malaysia. She is currently the treasurer of the ACM SIGCHI Kuala Lumpur Chapter (myHCI-UX). Her research interests include Music Interaction, Artificial Intelligence in Music, Immersive Technologies, and Mobile Interaction.

Dr. Juliana Aida Abu Bakar serves as Associate Professor at the School of Creative Industry Management & Performing Arts, UUM College of Arts & Sciences, Universiti Utara Malaysia. She holds the President of the ACM SIGCHI Kuala Lumpur Chapter or known as myHCI-UX. She dwells into virtual reality, augmented reality and their user experience design and evaluation.

Dr. Yohannes Kurniawan is an Associate Professor at the School of Information Systems, Bina Nusantara University (BINUS), Indonesia. His research interests vary from Implementing Human Information Behavior Concept for Design, Knowledge Management System in Hospital, Business Analytics and Digital Transformation in Education. He currently holds a strategic role as the Dean of School of Information Systems at BINUS University, as well as prestigious positions in various associations as such co-founder and Vice Chair of *Asosiasi Sistem Informasi Indonesia* (ASII), and Chair of Indonesia ACM SIGCHI.

Dr. Ellya Zulaikha is an Associate Professor in Industrial Design Department and the Vice Dean for the Faculty of Creative Design and Digital Business, Institut Teknologi Sepuluh Nopember Surabaya Indonesia. Ellya has rich experience in teaching and research activities, mainly in the field of design including creativity, design method and community engagement using design approach (Participatory Design). Design thinking and its application in many fields of interdisciplinary cases is her interest. Ellya has experience in design research related to human centred design such as experiential dining, plastic recycling to medical equipment design.

Auzi Asfarian is a Lecturer at the Department of Computer Science, IPB University, Bogor, Indonesia. He is a member of Software Engineering and Information Science and works on research projects of digital innovation for empowering the agriculture community.

7 CALL FOR PARTICIPATION

The Asian CHI Symposium invites the latest and original HCI research papers from Asian countries and those focusing on incorporating Asian sociocultural factors in their design and implementation. The symposium aims to promote its unique problems and approaches to the global community. We invite young and senior researchers and practitioners in this symposium.

7.1 Submission

This year we welcome two types of submissions; (1) Original Works and (2) Showcase. The Original Work highlights novel works in the form of (1) completed studies or systems, (2) preliminary results, or (3) an extension or a discussion of an alternative perspective of previously published work. These submissions can either be in the form of (1) paper (pages must be between 5-10 pages including references and acknowledgment), or (2) poster or demo (up to 4 pages including references and acknowledgment) in CHI 2023 Extended Abstract format.

The Showcase are works that will be presented at other CHI 2023 tracks, other published HCI materials. They could be presented at the symposium to broaden the dissemination of high-quality published research and to inspire applications, replications, continuation, spin-offs and collaboration. All types of submissions are not anonymized and uploaded through the symposium website.

7.2 Review Process

Each original submission will receive at least two anonymized reviews. The submissions under the *Showcase* category will be curated by taking into account the following factors: the number of the accepted original submissions; the geographical diversity of the attendees; and the diversity of research topics. The symposium submission process allows all authors to get feedback to improve their research before presenting it in the symposium.

7.3 Shepherding Process

On occasions when reviewers point out prominent research with empirical evidence, yet have not reached the level of quality required for the publication, a shepherding process begins with the interest of the author to resubmit an improved paper. In order to improve the paper, shepherding reviewers will be assigned to the paper to advise and monitor changes based on the requirement and finally aid authors to outcome a quality research publication.

7.4 Registration

At least one author of each accepted submission must be registered for either physical or remote attendance and presentation. All participants, both authors, and audience must register for the Asian CHI Symposium as defined by the CHI 2023 committee.

7.5 Website

The symposium website's URL will be <https://asianchi.net>.

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